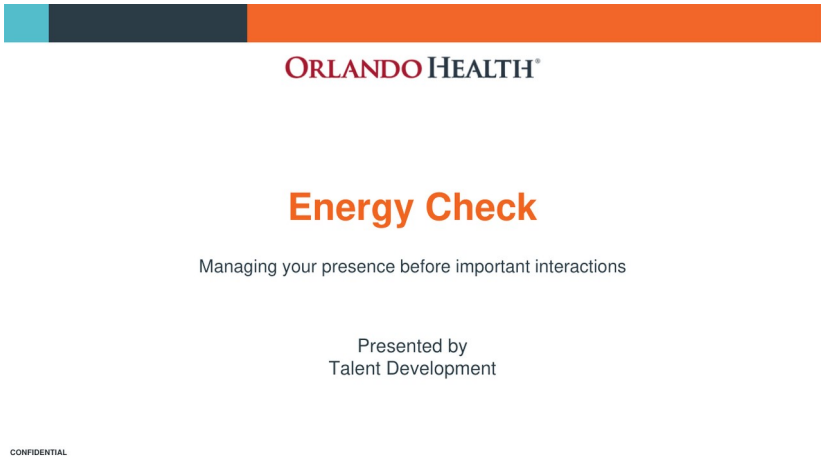
Energy Check

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Energy Check



TIMING: 1:00 | 0:00–1:00

SESSION: Target 13 minutes, including brief discussion. For 12 minutes, take one response per prompt. For 15 minutes, allow one additional example.

SAY:

Welcome to today's Nurse Leader Huddle. Today's topic is Energy Check: managing your presence before important interactions. Here, energy means the mental and emotional capacity you bring and how your current state shows up in your pace, tone, attention, and patience.

ASK:

If you walked into your next meeting right now, what might your team notice about you?

FACILITATE:

Allow 15 seconds of private reflection. Sharing is optional.

SAY:

You may be tired, focused, distracted, or feeling pressure. Today we will practice noticing that state and choosing a response that fits what the team needs.

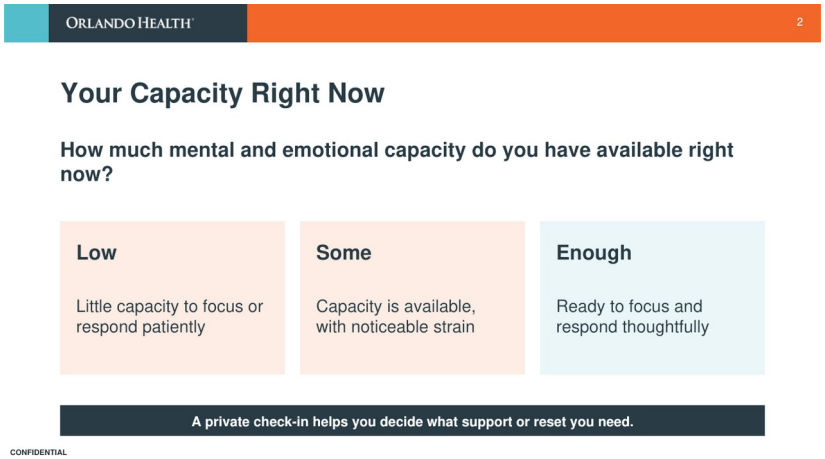
TRANSITION:

Let's start by checking how much capacity you have available.

Energy Check

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Your Capacity Right Now



TIMING: 1:20 | 1:00–2:20

SAY:

Privately ask yourself: How much mental and emotional capacity do I have available right now?

Low means you have little capacity to focus or respond patiently. Some means capacity is available, but you notice strain. Enough means you feel ready to focus and respond thoughtfully. This is a reflection tool, not a diagnostic scale or a performance rating.

FACILITATE:

Give 15 seconds for a private check-in. Do not ask participants to disclose a rating.

ASK:

How might your current capacity show up in your pace, tone, attention, or patience? What support or reset would help before the next interaction?

SAY:

A calm appearance does not necessarily mean you have enough capacity, and high activation does not necessarily mean you are ready to respond well. The purpose is to notice what you need. Leaders do not need to be positive all the time.

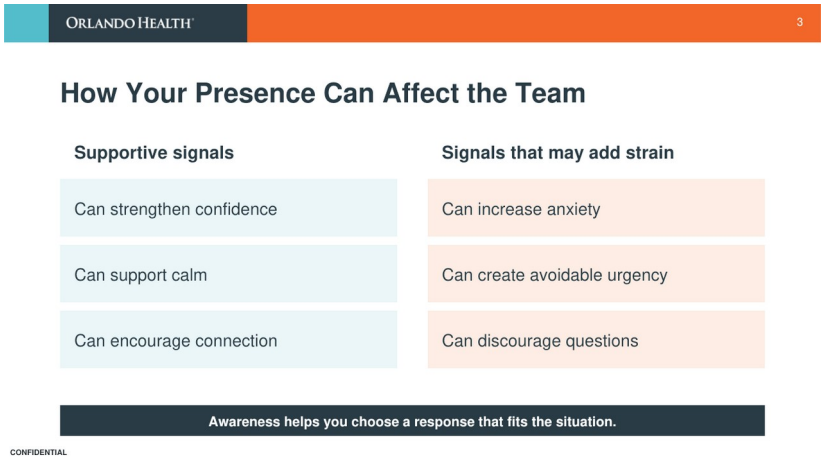
TRANSITION:

How we show up can affect what the team experiences.

Energy Check

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How Your Presence Can Affect the Team



TIMING: 1:15 | 2:20–3:35

SAY:

People notice a leader's pace, tone, body language, responsiveness, and attention. Those signals can strengthen confidence, support calm, and encourage connection. They can also increase anxiety, create avoidable urgency, or discourage questions.

These are possible effects, not guaranteed outcomes. The team, context, and situation matter. Appropriate urgency can be necessary. Unclear urgency or a rushed tone can make it harder for people to understand what action is actually needed.

EXAMPLE:

Compare “We need this fixed now” with “This needs attention today. Here is the immediate priority, and here is when we will check progress.” The second statement makes the next action clearer without pretending there is no pressure.

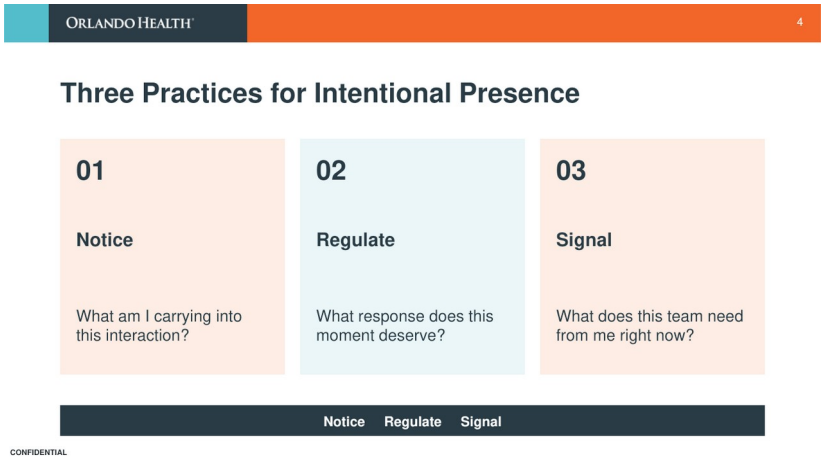
TRANSITION:

Three practices can help you choose how to show up.

Energy Check

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Three Practices for Intentional Presence



TIMING: 1:25 | 3:35–5:00

SAY:

There are three practices that can help us manage our leadership presence.

Notice. Regulate. Signal.

These practices help us move from reacting automatically to leading intentionally.

A brief pause can help in some situations. Persistent overload may also require a change in workload or additional support. Let's look at each practice.

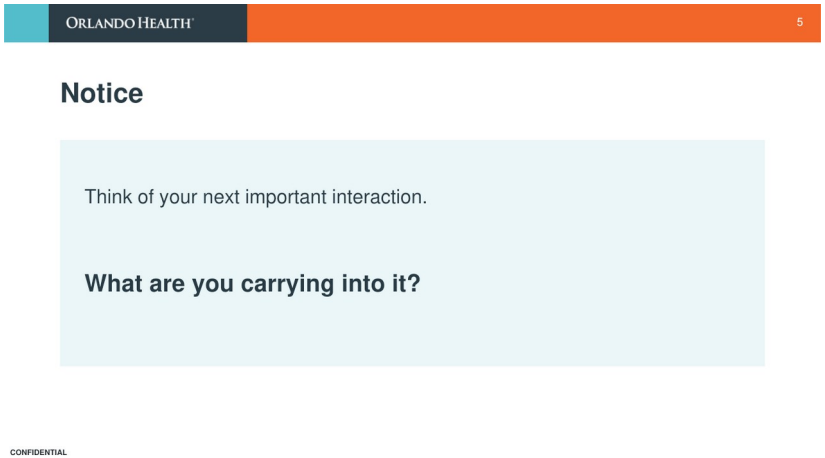
TRANSITION:

The first practice is Notice.

Energy Check

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Notice



TIMING: 1:25 | 5:00–6:25

SAY:

Notice is the first practice. Think of your next meeting, huddle, rounding conversation, or difficult discussion.

ASK:

What are you carrying into that interaction? You might feel rushed, distracted, frustrated, tired, anxious, or calm.

FACILITATE:

Allow 20 seconds of private reflection. Then ask: How might that state show up in your pace, tone, patience, or attention? What impact could it have on the conversation? Invite one voluntary response without asking for personal details.

DEBRIEF:

Awareness gives you information you can use. Name your current state without judging it. Then decide what response would help the interaction. Noticing alone does not solve workload or other pressures, but it can help you identify a need for support.

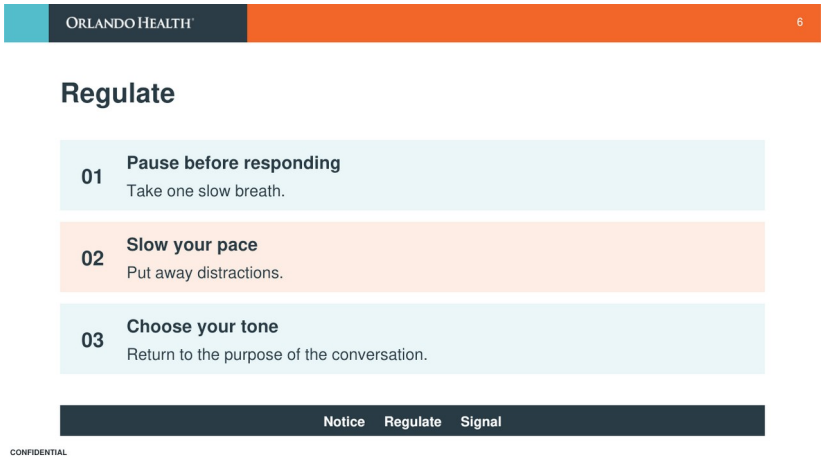
TRANSITION:

Once you notice what you are carrying, consider how to regulate your response.

Energy Check

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Regulate



TIMING: 1:25 | 6:25–7:50

SAY:

Once we notice what we're carrying, the next step is regulation.

Regulation does not mean denying what we are experiencing. It means pausing long enough to choose a response rather than simply reacting.

Sometimes that reset may be as simple as taking one slow breath, slowing your pace, putting away distractions, or reviewing the purpose of the conversation.

Leaders cannot always control what they feel, but they can often influence how they respond. A brief reset may help. If you are too depleted to engage effectively, consider what support or change is possible rather than relying only on a pause.

TRANSITION:

Once we regulate our own response, we can become intentional about what we communicate to others.

Energy Check

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Signal



TIMING: 1:25 | 7:50–9:15

SAY:

Signal means choosing what others need to experience from you. Ask: What does this team need from me right now?

Be fully present. Put away distractions when possible and make room for questions.

Name reality clearly. Acknowledge the challenge without adding avoidable alarm or promising an outcome you cannot guarantee.

Model steadiness. Clarify what is known, what needs attention, and what happens next. Depending on the situation, the team may need calm, focus, compassion, curiosity, or appropriate urgency.

EXAMPLE:

“This is a difficult situation. We do not have every answer yet. Here is what we know, here is the next step, and here is when I will update you.”

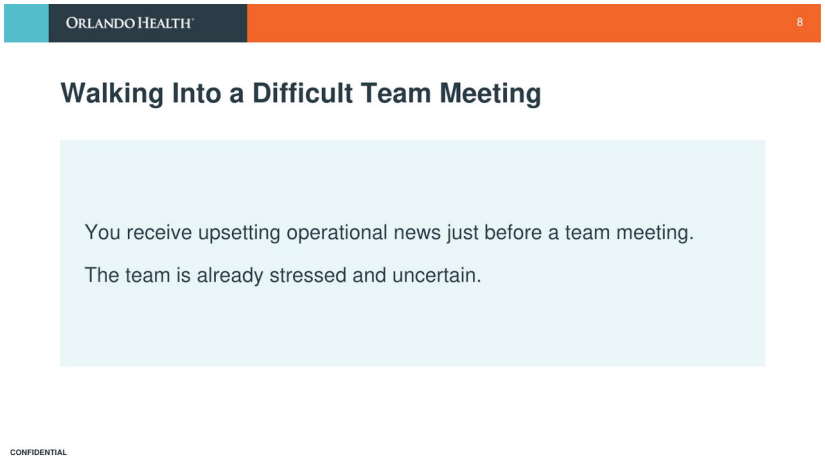
FACILITATOR TIP:

Intentional presence does not require forced positivity. Match your words and behavior to the situation.

TRANSITION:

Let's apply Notice, Regulate, and Signal to a difficult meeting.

Walking Into a Difficult Team Meeting



TIMING: 2:15 | 9:15–11:30

SAY:

You receive upsetting news about an operational issue just before a team meeting. You feel frustrated and distracted. The team is already stressed and uncertain, and they have questions.

ASK:

Using Notice, Regulate, and Signal, how would you prepare and what would you say first?

FACILITATE:

Allow 20 seconds of thought, then invite two brief responses. Keep the discussion focused on the opening interaction rather than solving the entire operational issue.

DEBRIEF:

Notice: identify the frustration or distraction you are carrying and how it may affect your tone.

Regulate: take a brief pause, slow your pace, and return to the meeting's immediate purpose. Consider whether you need support.

Signal: acknowledge the difficult situation, explain what you know, and make the next step clear. Avoid pretending everything is fine or giving assurances you cannot support.

EXAMPLE:

“I know there is uncertainty. Let me start with what we know today, what needs our attention first, and when we will have another update.”

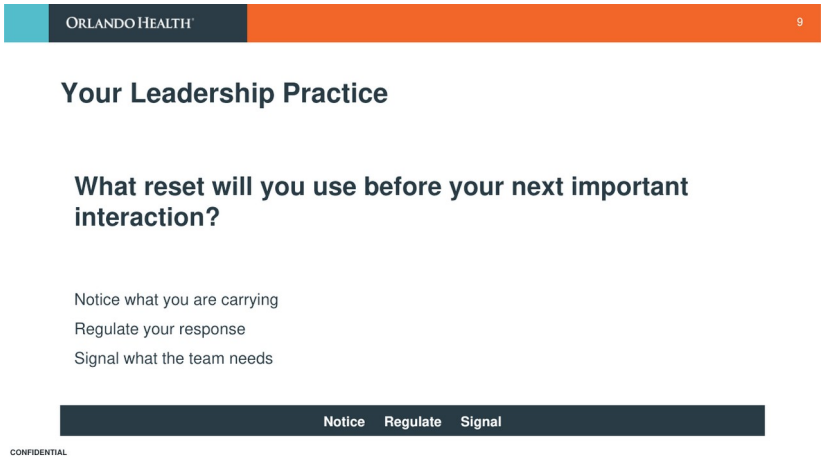
TRANSITION:

Choose one reset for your own next important interaction.

Energy Check

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Your Leadership Practice



TIMING: 1:30 | 11:30–13:00

SAY:

Think about your next huddle, meeting, or difficult conversation. What are you carrying? What reset would help you respond thoughtfully? What signal does the team need from you?

CHAT ENGAGEMENT:

Allow 15 seconds of private reflection. Ask: “What reset will you use before your next important interaction?” Pause 20 to 30 seconds for chat responses, or invite two brief verbal responses in person. Acknowledge the connection between the reset and the signal the leader wants to send.

CLOSE:

Notice what you are carrying. Regulate your response. Signal what the team needs. Before the next interaction, pause and choose how you want to show up. Thank you for being here.